

Series Tech Limited Human Resources Policies

Full Human Resources Operational Policy, Leave Governance, Hybrid Working & Compliance Manual (v3.2)

1. Purpose & Scope

This document describes the complete set of Human Resources policies at **Series Tech Limited** governing leave entitlement, accrual rules, holiday calendars, attendance logging, late coming discipline, hybrid work, remote security, overtime, parental/special leaves, employee wellness, disciplinary escalation frameworks, separation settlements, attendance corrections, and decision matrices. It is written as a self-contained operational reference for all personnel without requiring supplementary documentation.

Scope: Applies to all full-time employees, part-time staff, probationers, interns, and contractors operating across Hyderabad, Bangalore, Pune, Chennai, and Mumbai operating hubs.

Related Policies: Payroll & Finance Policy v5.0, IT Services and Employee Assets Policy, Code of Conduct, Information Security Policy, Travel & Expense Policy, and Employee Benefits Policy.

2. Leave Entitlement & Accrual

Leave allocations operate on a calendar year basis (January 1 to December 31). Confirmed employees receive 15 days of Earned Leave (EL), 8 days of Casual Leave (CL), and 10 days of Sick Leave (SL) per year. Leave accrues on a pro-rata basis at the beginning of each calendar month for new joiners. Employees joining mid-year receive pro-rated CL and SL immediately, while Earned Leave begins accruing upon successful completion of probation. Casual and Sick leave balances lapse on December 31st.

2.1 Leave Accrual Matrix

Employee Type	Earned Leave	Casual Leave	Sick Leave
Confirmed Employee	15 days/year	8 days/year	10 days/year
Probationer	After confirmation	Pro-rata	Pro-rata
Mid-Year Joiner	Pro-rata after confirmation	Pro-rata	Pro-rata
Intern	As per internship terms	Pro-rata	Pro-rata
Contractor	Vendor contract	Vendor contract	Vendor contract

2.2 Leave Calculation Scenarios & Examples

Scenario A (Mid-Year Joiner - July 1): An employee joining on July 1st receives pro-rated Casual Leave (4 days) and Sick Leave (5 days) for the remaining 6 months. Earned Leave accrues only after probation confirmation.

Scenario B (Probation Period): A probationer cannot take Earned Leave. If Casual/Sick leave balances are exhausted, any additional leave is processed as Loss of Pay (LWP).

Scenario C (Resignation with 25 EL Days): Unused Earned Leave (up to 30 days maximum) is encashed as part of the Full-and-Final (FnF) settlement calculation.

3. Leave Carry-Forward, Encashment & Modification

Earned Leave can be carried forward up to a maximum balance limit of 30 days into subsequent calendar years. Any Earned Leave balance accumulated beyond 30 days automatically lapses at the end of the year without encashment. Upon resignation or retirement, accumulated Earned Leave up to the maximum 30-day limit is encashed as part of Full-and-Final (FnF) settlement. Casual Leave, Sick Leave, and Compensatory Offs are strictly non-encashable.

Modification & Cancellation Rules: Approved leave requests can be canceled or withdrawn via the internal HR Portal prior to the leave start date. Once the leave period has commenced, cancellation requires Reporting Manager verification and HR Operations approval to restore accrued leave balances.

4. Holiday Calendar & Holiday Rules

Human Resources publishes the location-specific 12-day annual holiday calendar prior to January 1st for each office hub (Hyderabad, Bangalore, Pune, Chennai, Mumbai). The applicable holiday calendar is determined by the employee's assigned office location unless otherwise specified by HR. If a declared public holiday falls on a weekend, it is counted within the 12-day roster without substitute days off unless mandated by state labor authorities. Employees required to work on a declared public holiday are eligible for 1 day of Compensatory Off.

5. Attendance & Office Timings

Standard office hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM (Monday through Friday). In-office presence requires physical biometric badge tapping. Remote attendance requires online portal check-in between 9:00 AM and 9:45 AM. Core working hours during which all employees must remain online and reachable are 10:30 AM to 4:30 PM.

5.1 Attendance Correction Workflow

Employees must raise attendance correction requests through the HR Portal within 3 working days of identifying an incorrect attendance record (e.g., forgotten biometric tap, remote check-in error, or system outage). Reporting Managers review the request, and HR Operations updates the official attendance record upon approval.

6. Late Coming & Attendance Discipline

Arrivals after 9:45 AM without prior manager approval are flagged as Late Arrivals. Employees are allowed up to 3 late arrivals per month without penalty. The 4th late arrival results in a formal verbal reminder from the Reporting Manager. 5 or more late arrivals trigger formal HR attendance counseling and potential Loss of Pay (LWP) deductions.

7. WFH & Hybrid Work

Series Tech Limited operates under a structured hybrid model requiring minimum in-office days set by Department Heads (typically 2–3 days per week).

7.1 WFH Cutoff & Governance Matrix

Activity / Work Arrangement	Requirement & Governance Rule
Remote Check-in Window	9:00 AM – 9:45 AM on online portal
Standard Office Hours	9:30 AM – 6:30 PM (Mon–Fri)
Core Working Hours	10:30 AM – 4:30 PM (Reachable online)
Short-Term WFH	Manager approval 24 hours prior via HR portal
Emergency WFH	Notify manager before 9:30 AM via Slack/email
Extended WFH (> 5 days)	Dual approval from Manager + Department Head
International WFH	Explicit sign-off from HR Director + CFO
Permanent Remote Work	Executive sign-off from HR Director + Department Head + CFO

8. Remote Work Security

Remote work must be conducted exclusively on corporate-issued laptops with active VPN and EDR security agents. Connecting to corporate networks from public, unencrypted Wi-Fi networks without an active VPN is strictly prohibited.

9. Overtime & Comp-Off

Pre-approved work performed beyond standard working hours or on weekends/holidays qualifies for overtime or Compensatory Off (Comp-Off). Overtime or Compensatory Off eligibility depends on employee classification, applicable law, and prior approval. Additional working hours do not automatically qualify for monetary overtime. Working a full day on a weekend or holiday yields 1 Comp-Off day, which must be availed within 60 calendar days or it automatically lapses without encashment.

10. Leave Approval Workflow

10.1 Leave Approval Governance Matrix

Request Type	Reporting Manager	Department Head	Human Resources
Leave < 5 days	Approve	—	Record
Leave > 5 days	Approve	Approve	Record
Emergency Leave	Review	If required	Record
Maternity Leave	Acknowledge	—	Approve/Record

Request Type	Reporting Manager	Department Head	Human Resources
Extended Medical Leave	Review	—	Approve
Comp-Off	Approve	If required	Record
Notice Period Leave	Review	Approve	Record

11. Parental & Special Leave

Eligible male employees receive 15 consecutive calendar days of paid paternity leave, to be availed within six months of the child's birth. Employees should notify HR as early as reasonably possible before the expected delivery date.

11.1 Parental & Special Leave Governance Matrix

Leave Type	Target Eligibility	Paid Duration	Mandatory Advance Notice
Maternity Leave	Eligible female employees	26 Weeks fully paid	60 days advance notice to HR
Paternity Leave	Eligible male employees	15 Consecutive Days	Notify HR as early as possible
Adoption Leave	Primary adoptive mother	12 Weeks fully paid	Legal placement documentation
Surrogacy Leave	Primary surrogate mother	12 Weeks fully paid	Legal surrogate documentation
Extended Medical	All confirmed staff	Unpaid (Subject to HR)	Medical certificate > 3 days

12. Extended Medical Leave

Unpaid medical leave can be requested when illness exceeds available Sick Leave balances. Leaves exceeding 30 consecutive days require bi-weekly medical updates and a fit-to-work certificate prior to rejoining.

13. Employee Wellness & EAP

Series Tech Limited provides a confidential Employee Assistance Program (EAP) offering 24/7 mental health counseling, stress management, and personal wellness support. Sessions are completely confidential and unlinked from employee personnel files.

14. Disciplinary & Attendance Escalation

Absence without notification for 3 consecutive working days triggers the Unauthorized Absence/Absconding workflow.

Attendance non-compliance, unauthorized absence, or WFH rule violations follow a structured 6-level escalation framework: Level 1 (Verbal Reminder), Level 2 (HR Attendance Counseling), Level 3 (Written Warning Letter), Level 4 (30–60 Day AIP), Level 5 (Formal Disciplinary Action & WFH Suspension), and Level 6 (Employment Termination / Absconding Resolution).

15. HR & Leave Decision Matrix

Question: How much Earned Leave do I receive per year?

Answer: Confirmed employees receive 15 days of Earned Leave per calendar year.

Question: Can I carry forward Earned Leave?

Answer: Yes, Earned Leave can be carried forward up to a maximum balance of 30 days.

Question: What happens to excess Earned Leave beyond 30 days?

Answer: Accumulated Earned Leave beyond 30 days automatically lapses at year-end without encashment.

Question: Can I take Earned Leave during probation?

Answer: No. Earned Leave accrues only after employee confirmation. Probationers receive Casual and Sick Leave on a pro-rata basis.

Question: How do I apply for planned leave?

Answer: Submit leave applications through the internal HR Portal at least 3 working days in advance.

Question: Who approves leave longer than 5 consecutive working days?

Answer: Leave exceeding 5 days requires dual sign-off from both the Reporting Manager and Department Head.

Question: What happens if my manager doesn't approve my leave ticket?

Answer: If no action is taken within 2 working days, the ticket automatically escalates to the Department Head.

Question: How many days of WFH are permitted under standard hybrid working?

Answer: In-office requirements are set by Department Heads, typically requiring 2–3 days in office per week.

Question: Can I work remotely from another country?

Answer: No. International remote work requires explicit written sign-off from the HR Director and CFO due to corporate tax regulations.

Question: What are the core working hours during remote work?

Answer: 10:30 AM to 4:30 PM. Employees must remain active and reachable during this window.

Question: Can I work from home without manager notification?

Answer: No. WFH requires prior manager notification or approval on the HR portal.

Question: How is Compensatory Off earned?

Answer: Working a full pre-approved day on a declared holiday or weekend yields 1 Compensatory Off day.

Question: When does Compensatory Off expire?

Answer: Compensatory Off must be availed within 60 calendar days of being earned or it automatically lapses.

Question: Can Compensatory Off be encashed?

Answer: No. Compensatory Off cannot be encashed under any circumstance.

Question: What happens if I am absent without notice for 3 days?

Answer: Absence without notification for 3 consecutive working days triggers the Unauthorized Absence/Absconding workflow.

Question: How is maternity leave requested?

Answer: Eligible female employees submit maternity requests with medical proof at least 60 days in advance.

Question: How long is paternity leave?

Answer: Eligible male employees receive 15 consecutive calendar days of paid paternity leave, to be availed within six months of the child's birth.

Question: What happens to my Earned Leave when I resign?

Answer: Accumulated Earned Leave up to the 30-day limit is encashed as part of Full-and-Final (FnF) settlement.

Question: Can I take leave during my notice period?

Answer: Leave during notice period is generally discouraged and requires Department Head approval; unapproved leave extends notice period.

Question: Who is the official Policy Owner for HR Policies?

Answer: Head of Human Resources.

16. Leave & Attendance Cutoff Matrix

HR / Attendance Activity	Operational Cutoff / SLA Deadline
Monthly Attendance Data Freeze	22nd of each calendar month
Planned Leave Request Submission	At least 3 working days in advance
Manager Leave Ticket Approval SLA	Within 2 working days before auto-escalation

HR / Attendance Activity	Operational Cutoff / SLA Deadline
Compensatory Off Utilization Deadline	Within 60 calendar days from date earned
Medical Certificate Submission	Mandatory for Sick Leave exceeding 3 days
Maternity Leave Advance Notice	At least 60 calendar days prior to leave start
Casual & Sick Leave Expiry	December 31st annually (Lapses automatically)
Late Arrival Grace Window	9:30 AM to 9:45 AM (Max 3 allowed/month)
Daily Remote Check-in Window	9:00 AM to 9:45 AM on online portal

17. Employee Separation & Leave Settlement

During exit clearance, accumulated Earned Leave up to the maximum limit of 30 days is encashed during Full-and-Final (FnF) settlement. Casual Leave, Sick Leave, and Compensatory Off balances lapse upon resignation and are non-encashable. Leave during notice period requires Department Head sign-off.

18. HR Access, Records & Confidentiality

Personnel files and leave/attendance records are classified as Confidential/Restricted. Access is restricted under strict Role-Based Access Control (RBAC):

18.1 HR RBAC Matrix

Role	Authorized System Access Level
Employee	Own leave, attendance, HR records
Reporting Manager	Direct-report leave and attendance
Department Head	Department-level HR information
HR Operations	Employee master and HR records
HR Director	HR governance and sensitive records
CFO	Financial/compliance information where applicable
Internal Audit	Controlled read-only audit access

19. Frequently Asked Questions (Exactly 60 FAQs)

1. How many earned leave days do I get per year at Series Tech Limited?

15 days per calendar year for confirmed employees.

2. How many casual leave days do I get?

8 days per calendar year.

3. How many sick leave days do I get?

10 days per calendar year.

4. Can earned leave be carried forward?

Yes, up to a maximum balance of 30 days into the following year.

5. Does casual leave carry forward?

No, casual leave lapses automatically on December 31st.

6. How far in advance should I apply for earned leave?

At least three working days in advance through the HR portal.

7. Who approves my leave request?

Your reporting manager; leave exceeding 5 days also requires Department Head approval.

8. What is the maternity leave duration at Series Tech Limited?

26 weeks of paid maternity leave.

9. What is the paternity leave duration?

15 consecutive calendar days of paid paternity leave.

10. When should paternity leave be availed?

Within six months of the child's birth.

11. What happens if I exceed my sick leave balance?

You may apply for unpaid medical leave with a valid medical certificate and HR approval.

12. What is the late coming threshold?

Up to three late arrivals per month without formal action.

13. What happens if I am late more than five times in a month?

It results in formal attendance counseling by HR and potential loss-of-pay deductions.

14. How do I record overtime?

Overtime must be pre-approved through the internal HR portal prior to extra hours worked.

15. What is compensatory leave?

Leave granted for working on a declared holiday or weekend, to be availed within sixty days.

16. Can I work from home whenever I want?

No, you must inform your manager in advance and adhere to your department's hybrid schedule.

17. What are the core working hours under the hybrid model?

10:30 AM to 4:30 PM.

18. Can interns avail earned leave?

No, interns receive casual/sick leave on a pro-rata basis but not earned leave.

19. Can contractors use the Series Tech Limited leave portal?

Contractors follow leave terms specified in their vendor contract.

20. What happens if my manager does not approve my leave request in time?

It escalates automatically to the department head after two working days.

21. What documents are required for maternity leave?

A medical certificate confirming pregnancy and expected delivery date.

22. What documents are required for extended medical leave?

A valid medical certificate, with periodic updates for leave exceeding 30 days.

23. Can leave be rejected during critical project milestones?

Yes, subject to Series Tech Limited offering reasonable alternative scheduling.

24. Is attendance tracked differently when working remotely?

Yes, via online portal check-in instead of office biometric scanners.

25. What happens if I do not submit a medical certificate for sick leave exceeding three days?

The absence may be treated as unauthorized absence (Loss of Pay).

26. Can compensatory leave be encashed?

No, compensatory leave must be taken as time off within 60 days or it lapses.

27. Who declares the annual holiday calendar?

Human Resources declares location-specific holiday calendars annually.

28. Does the holiday calendar differ by branch office?

Yes, it reflects regional public holidays in Hyderabad, Bangalore, Pune, Chennai, and Mumbai.

29. What if I need leave with less than three working days' notice?

You must discuss the situation with your manager for discretionary approval.

30. Who do I contact with questions about my leave balance?

Your reporting manager or the Human Resources helpdesk portal.

31. How is pro-rata leave calculated for mid-year joiners?

Calculated proportionally based on remaining full months in the calendar year.

32. What is the maximum Earned Leave encashment limit upon exit?

Up to 30 days of eligible accumulated Earned Leave.

33. Can Earned Leave be taken during probation?

No, Earned Leave accrues only after employee confirmation.

34. Is adoption leave provided for male employees?

Male primary adopters receive 15 days of paternity/adoption leave.

35. What is the duration of adoption leave for female primary adopters?

12 weeks of fully paid adoption leave.

36. Can I take remote work from an international location?

No, international remote work requires explicit written approval from HR Director and CFO.

37. How is half-day leave applied?

Applied via the HR portal by selecting Morning or Afternoon session options.

38. What happens if an employee is absent without notice for 3 consecutive working days?

Absence without notification for 3 consecutive working days triggers the Unauthorized Absence/Absconding workflow.

39. Are office access badges mandatory on in-office days?

Yes, physical badges must be tapped for entry to log biometric attendance.

40. What is the daily check-in window for remote days?

Portal check-in must occur between 9:00 AM and 9:45 AM.

41. Can Comp-Off be utilized during notice period?

Comp-Off utilization during notice period requires Department Head pre-approval.

42. What happens to unused Casual Leave on December 31st?

Lapses automatically without roll-over or encashment.

43. Is leave encashment taxable?

Yes, leave encashment upon resignation is taxed as per statutory income tax rules.

44. Who defines the minimum in-office days under hybrid work?

The Department Head in alignment with corporate HR policy.

45. What happens if a public holiday falls on a weekend?

It is counted within the annual 12-day declared holiday roster without substitute days off.

46. Are Employee Assistance Program (EAP) services confidential?

Yes, EAP counseling is 100% confidential and unlinked from HR records.

47. Who approves extended WFH requests exceeding 5 days?

Dual approval from Reporting Manager and Department Head.

48. How many levels are in the attendance escalation framework?

6 levels, ranging from verbal reminder to employment termination.

49. What happens if I submit false attendance records?

Subject to immediate Level 4/5 disciplinary action and potential termination.

50. Can negative leave balances be carried forward?

No, unapproved excess leave is treated as Loss of Pay (LWP) in the current month.

51. Can I cancel an approved leave request?

Yes, leave cancellation can be requested on the HR portal before the leave date.

52. Does public holiday count as leave if it falls during approved Earned Leave?

No, declared public holidays falling within an approved leave window are excluded from leave deduction.

53. What is the notice period for paternity leave?

Employees should notify HR as early as reasonably possible before the expected delivery date.

54. Can probationers avail Casual Leave?

Yes, Casual Leave is credited on a pro-rata basis during probation.

55. How is surrogacy leave granted?

Primary surrogate mothers receive 12 weeks of paid leave upon legal documentation.

56. What happens to pending Comp-Offs upon resignation?

Comp-Offs cannot be encashed and lapse upon resignation.

57. Who approves permanent remote work requests?

HR Director, Department Head, and CFO.

58. What is the response SLA for HR ticketing queries?

HR resolves standard policy tickets within 3 working days.

59. Can leave be withdrawn after approval if plans change?

Yes, via HR portal withdrawal request prior to the leave start date.

60. Who is the designated Policy Owner for this document?

Head of Human Resources.

20. Policy Governance & Exceptions

Owned by Head of Human Resources. Reviewed annually or upon labor law updates. Policy exceptions require written approval from the HR Director.

21. Document Control & Revision History

Version	Effective Date	Summary of Changes	Approved By
1.0	January 2025	Initial Publication of Corporate HR Policies	Head of Human Resources
2.0	January 2026	Annual Review: Updated maternity duration and late coming thresholds	Head of Human Resources
3.0	July 2026	Enterprise Update: Added leave accrual, holiday rules, WFH matrix, EAP wellness, 6-level disciplinary framework, FnF leave rules, 20 decision Q&A, and 60 FAQs.	HR & Executive Board
3.2	July 2026	Production-Ready Standard: Added Leave Calculation Examples, Attendance Correction Workflow, Leave Modification Rules, and cross-policy references.	HR & Executive Board